

THREE REASONS TO PRAISE THE LORD

1 Chronicles 16:812 - 22-36 (NKJV) *“On that day David first delivered this psalm into the hand of Asaph and his brethren, to thank the Lord: 8 Oh, give thanks to the Lord! Call upon His name; Make known His deeds among the peoples! 9 Sing to Him, sing psalms to Him; Talk of all His wondrous works! 10 Glory in His holy name; Let the hearts of those rejoice who seek the Lord! 11 Seek the Lord and His strength; Seek His face evermore! 12 Remember His marvelous works which He has done, His wonders, and the judgments of His mouth. 23 Sing to the Lord, all the earth; Proclaim the good news of His salvation from day to day. 24 Declare His glory among the nations, His wonders among all peoples. 25 For the Lord is great and greatly to be praised; He is also to be*

feared above all gods. 26 For all the gods of the peoples are idols, But the Lord made the heavens. 27 Honor and majesty are before Him; Strength and gladness are in His place. 28 Give to the Lord, O families of the peoples, Give to the Lord glory and strength. 29 Give to the Lord the glory due His name; Bring an offering, and come before Him. Oh, worship the Lord in the beauty of holiness! 30 Tremble before Him, all the earth. The world also is firmly established, It shall not be moved. 31 Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad; And let them say among the nations, "The Lord reigns." 32 Let the sea roar, and all its fullness; Let the field rejoice, and all that is in it. 33 Then the trees of the woods shall rejoice before the Lord, For He is coming to judge the earth. 34 Oh, give thanks to the Lord, for He is good! For His mercy endures forever. 35 And say, "Save us, O God of our salvation;

Gather us together, and deliver us from the Gentiles, To give thanks to Your holy name, To triumph in Your praise.” 36 Blessed be the Lord God of Israel From everlasting to everlasting! And all the people said, “Amen!” and praised the Lord.”

INTRO: 1 Chronicles 16 is one of the first times the expression “***Give Thanks***” is used in the Bible. I stand to echo the words of the Psalmist who said, “***Give thanks.***”

Thanksgiving should not be a one-time-a-year event but the daily practice of every Christian.

In this passage David is welcoming the Ark of the Covenant back to its rightful place in the tabernacle among the appliances of worship.

I want to give you three reasons from 1 Chronicles 16 that we should live a thankful life by giving thanks to the Lord.

I. WE SHOULD BE THANKFUL THAT HE IS A GOD OF SECOND CHANCES...

David had just attempted to relocate the Ark of God from the house of Abinadab to Jerusalem. Remember, in the Old Testament, the Ark was where God lived among His people.

David was bringing the Ark back to Jerusalem, however, it wasn't handled correctly and David's good intentions ended in disaster with the death of Uzza. David attempted to do a good thing the wrong way.

Even though his first attempt ended in a catastrophe, God allowed him another chance and this time he succeeded.

David then authors a psalm of thanksgiving in 1 Chronicles 16. You can tell he is deeply grateful to the Lord, as we should all be, when we have another shot to get something right.

One thing David admonished us to do in verse 10 is to give “***glory in His Holy name,***” which means we should bask in who He is in order to keep our hearts filled with gratitude.

One verse about God’s name that comes to mind is something else David said in Psalm 90:2. He says of the Lord, “***from everlasting to everlasting you are God.***” David is saying from beginning to end, from eternity past to eternity present, He is God!

And because of this, He sees our lives from a far bigger picture than we do. We are ready to give up after one attempt but God encourages us to keep moving forward: “*If*

at first we don't succeed, try try, again!"
(Thomas H. Parker)

God remains steadfastly at work in us long after we have given up on ourselves.

I'm thankful that God doesn't dwell on our short-term failures but rather, works in us for our long-term potential.

When we mess up and fess up, God moves on, and so should we! The problem is that we get high-centered in our mess when God is attempting to coax us into a new opportunity.

He will extend a second chance, or even a third, fourth, and fifth if necessary in order to see his will prevail in our lives. That is a very good reason to give thanks!

II. WE SHOULD BE THANKFUL THAT GOD CREATES BIG THINGS FROM SMALL BEGINNINGS...

In this Psalm of thanks, David recalls the history of God's people and God's faithfulness to them up to the present point.

Let me pause and throw in a principle of gratitude worth remembering:

Remembering God's faithfulness in our PAST should help us REJOICE in our PRESENT because His PAST RECORD is a good indicator of His FUTURE ACTIVITY!

In this passage, David recalls just how fragile and small God's people started out. They went to Egypt a family (66 people) and left a nation (Of 2 ½ - 3 million people).

In Canaan the story is even greater, they multiplied exponentially and became a nation of multiplied millions.

David says in verses 19-20, “*When they were but few in number, few indeed, and strangers in it, they wandered from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another.*” David says, “*This whole thing started small, but God did big things to get us to this point!*”

And God still does today:

- He is still able to calm a storm...
- He can still multiply the loaves and the fish...
- He can still stop the mouths of hungry lions...
- He can still rob a furnace of its fire...
- He can still order the steps of good people...
- He is still a rewarder to those who diligently seek Him...

Here is a truth we must never forget: “*In seasons of WANDERING we lose our WONDER!*”

In those seasons when we feel small and WANDER aimlessly because we fail to understand what in the world is going on, we cannot allow ourselves to lose our WONDER of God.

Here is a good definition of the word “wander” and “wonder” that is worth remembering:

- To *wander*-means to ponder the affairs of your life *without* God in mind...
- To *wonder*-means to ponder the affairs of your life *with* God and His character in mind...

Here is the difference between WANDERING and WONDER:

- One leads to despair, the other devotion...

- One leads to fear, and the other faith...
- One leads to doubt, the other to destiny...
- One leads to mistakes, the other to miracles...
- One leads to denial, the other to determination...

Let's keep our WONDER even in seasons of WANDERING, and do as God said in Zechariah 4:10 “***Do not despise the days of small beginnings.***” God made a nation of a family! Give thanks for small beginnings.

We see the present circumstances for what they are; God sees them for what they are going to be! If we could see what God sees we would quit WANDERING and engage in WONDERMENT!

III. WE SHOULD GIVE THANKS FOR HIS NAME...

David say's in verse 29, *“ascribe to the Lord the glory that is due his name.”*

In the beginning of this chapter, after the Ark of the Lord had been returned, David actually appointed people whose sole job was to continually offer thanksgiving to the Lord. He then encourages EVERYONE to do the same!

In other words, David was very intentional in offering gratitude to God, and so should we. We should ascribe to the Lord the praise that is due Him.

To ascribe means to assign or give credit, and that is exactly what we are doing when we express praise and gratitude to God.

However, there is a powerful principle when it comes to being intentional in our praise and here it is:

- Our praise ATTACHES us to the presence of God and DETACHES us from the presence of anything else that would drag us down!
- Essentially, when we ascribe praise to God, we attach ourselves to God's presence and we can say what David says in Psalm 16:11, *"You make known to me the path of life; you will fill me with joy in your presence, with eternal pleasures at your right hand."*

If we don't have anything else to praise Him for we should praise Him for His name:

- His name is a saving name...
- His name is a delivering name...
- His name is a healing name...
- His name is a redeeming name...
- His name is above every name...

CONCLUSION:

Here is a bottom line. We must not forget that:

- Our gratitude is a gateway to Gods blessing, and a giant leap forward to His glory...
- Our thanks is a trap to the enemy and a cry of triumph to our troubles...
- Our praise is poison to our perplexities and a passing lane to prosperity...
- Our worship is a weapon in the hands of God and a deathblow to the worries that crease our brows...

This truth alone makes me grateful for the privilege of offering thanksgiving itself to God!

SONG:

Desert Song – Hillsong

This is my prayer in the desert; when all that's within me feels dry.

This is my prayer and my hunger in me, My God is the God who provides.

And this is my prayer in the fire, In

weakness or trial or pain.

*There is a faith proved Of more worth than
gold, So refine me Lord through the flames.*

*And this is my prayer in my battle, When
triumph is still on its way.*

*I am a conqueror and co-heir with Christ,
So firm on His promise I'll stand.*

*All of my life, In every season You are still
God.*

*I have a reason to sing, I have a reason to
worship.*

I will bring praise

I will bring praise

No weapon formed against me shall remain

I will rejoice

I will declare

God is my victory and He is here